

FretGarden

Pedagogical Constitution

Chapter 17

Instructional Voice, Accessibility, and Content Quality Assurance

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Authority	Binding on all FretGarden content, systems, and decisions within the scope of Chapter 17
Primary Dependencies	Foundation; Chapters 2 through 16

This chapter defines how FretGarden communicates, includes, reviews, and governs educational content without weakening pedagogical integrity.

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1. Purpose

This chapter defines standards for instructional voice, learner-facing language, accessibility, equivalent demonstrations, content review, editorial quality, factual verification, pedagogical audit, approval, revision, and educational debt.

It ensures that high-quality pedagogy is communicated clearly and made available through accessible pathways without silently changing the capability being taught or claimed.

2. Constitutional Authority

This chapter is binding on lesson text, feedback, prompts, labels, diagrams, audio, video, assessments, help content, notifications, contributor workflows, and quality-assurance systems.

3. Governing Principle

Governing Rule: FretGarden MUST communicate with precision, respect, and practical clarity; provide access without false equivalence; and approve content only when factual, pedagogical, technical, and accessibility evidence supports release.

4. Core Distinctions

Simple is not simplistic. Friendly is not vague. Encouragement is not praise inflation. Accessibility is not reduced rigor. Equivalent access is not identical format. Editorial correctness is not pedagogical validity. Completion of review is not proof of quality.

5. Instructional Voice Model

The voice should be patient, direct, respectful, specific, and musically grounded. It should explain purpose, direct attention, acknowledge difficulty, identify next action, and preserve learner agency.

6. Tone

Tone must avoid condescension, hype, shame, sarcasm, fear, talent myths, and moral judgment about practice consistency. It should normalize error and forgetting without trivializing the work required.

7. Precision and Plain Language

Terminology should be accurate and introduced when it becomes useful. Sentences should prefer concrete actions and relationships over abstract motivational language.

Plain language may reduce complexity of expression but must not introduce false rules.

8. The Garden Metaphor

The garden metaphor may support patience, consistency, cultivation, seasons, pruning, and return. It is subordinate to literal instruction and must not obscure technical meaning.

Metaphorical density should decrease when the learner needs precise action or correction.

9. Encouragement

Encouragement should identify observable effort, strategy, correction, persistence, or improvement. Generic praise should not imply mastery or erase uncertainty.

10. Error Language

Errors must be described as information about a task or capability under known conditions. Labels should be actionable and temporary, never identity judgments.

11. Learner Status Language

Status terms must distinguish exposure, practice, emerging capability, readiness, retention, and mastery. 'Complete' must not imply learned when evidence does not support that claim.

12. Instructions and Prompts

Instructions should state the action, target, conditions, and stopping rule. Prompts should direct attention without revealing more than necessary.

13. Examples and Non-Examples

Examples should represent the intended relation and vary incidental features. Non-examples should expose boundaries without teaching stereotypes or confusing errors.

14. Terminology Governance

Each core term must have a canonical definition, accepted variants, prohibited ambiguities, capitalization policy, and cross-reference. Changes require review across all affected content.

15. Accessibility Principle

Accessibility is a design obligation from the beginning. It is not a late exception layer applied after a single default experience is complete.

16. Objective Integrity in Accessibility

An adaptation is valid only when it preserves the intended capability or clearly narrows the claim. Changing response mode may be equivalent; removing the target relationship is not.

17. Visual Accessibility

Content should support scalable text, adequate contrast, non-color cues, clear focus order, readable diagrams, consistent orientation, and alternatives for visual information.

18. Auditory Accessibility

Audio content should provide controls, transcripts or descriptions where meaningful, channel balance, volume consistency, and alternatives when the objective is not inherently auditory.

19. Motor Accessibility

Interfaces should support keyboard access, adjustable timing, target sizes, reduced precision demands, and alternate input where the musical objective permits.

20. Cognitive Accessibility

Content should manage novelty, chunking, language load, memory demand, and distraction. Supports may include previews, stepwise instructions, persistent references, and reduced simultaneous demands.

21. Neurodiversity and Attention

The system should support varied session lengths, predictable structure, optional reminders, reduced motion, and clear priorities without assuming one attention profile.

22. Language and Localization

Localization must preserve musical meaning, normative force, terminology consistency, reading level, and cultural context. Literal translation without domain review is insufficient.

23. Cultural and Repertoire Inclusion

Examples should avoid presenting one genre, culture, body, or learning history as the default musician. Representation should be substantive and musically accurate rather than decorative.

24. Equivalent Demonstrations

Equivalent demonstrations must specify what remains constant, what changes, and what claim is permitted. Accessibility notes belong in objective and assessment design, not only interface documentation.

25. Content Artifact Requirements

Every core artifact should identify owner, version, objective, prerequisites, evidence, review date, dependencies, accessibility considerations, and conformance status.

26. Factual Review

Music-theory statements, notation, tabs, chord spellings, tunings, examples, and technical instructions must be verified by qualified review and, where possible, mechanically checked.

27. Pedagogical Review

Reviewers must test objective alignment, cognitive load, scaffold plan, evidence validity, feedback, review, transfer, and learner-facing claims.

28. Technical Review

Interactive content must be tested for scoring, state transitions, audio timing, latency, randomization, accessibility semantics, and data recording. Technical correctness affects pedagogical validity.

29. Accessibility Review

Review must include automated checks, keyboard and assistive-technology testing, contrast and scaling inspection, alternative-response validation, and human evaluation of equivalent demonstrations.

30. Editorial Review

Editorial review covers grammar, consistency, terminology, hierarchy, instruction completeness, examples, link integrity, and formatting. It cannot substitute for domain or pedagogical review.

31. Review Independence

High-consequence content should receive review by someone other than its primary author. Automated tools may assist but cannot be the sole authority for nuanced musical or pedagogical judgments.

32. Approval States

Artifacts should move through draft, domain review, pedagogical review, accessibility review, technical validation, approved, published, monitored, and revision-required states as applicable.

33. Conformance Evidence

Approval records should preserve reviewer, date, scope, findings, exceptions, unresolved risks, and version. A checklist without evidence is insufficient for high-consequence claims.

34. Versioning

Material changes to objectives, evidence, progression, scoring, accessibility, or learner-facing claims require a new version and impact analysis.

35. Educational Debt

Temporary noncompliance must be logged with scope, consequence, mitigation, owner, review date, and resolution condition. Educational debt must not become a silent permanent standard.

36. Monitoring After Release

Published content should be monitored for error patterns, abandonment, contradictory evidence, accessibility failures, misleading claims, and learner reports. Engagement metrics alone do not establish quality.

37. Incident Response

Serious factual, safety, accessibility, scoring, or progression errors require containment, learner-impact analysis, correction, revalidation of affected records, and transparent internal documentation.

38. Research and Evidence Standards

Pedagogical claims should distinguish established evidence, informed practice, internal hypothesis, and product preference. Citations and rationale should be maintained for consequential standards.

39. Automated Content Generation

Generated content must undergo the same factual, pedagogical, accessibility, and editorial review as human-authored content. Model fluency is not evidence of correctness.

40. Automated Feedback

Automated feedback must state only what observable data supports, communicate uncertainty, and route ambiguous or high-stakes cases appropriately.

41. Contributor Responsibilities

Contributors must understand the constitution, use canonical terminology, document assumptions, preserve objective integrity, and escalate conflicts rather than silently resolve them by convenience.

42. Learner Feedback

Learner reports should be triaged as evidence about clarity, access, motivation, validity, or technical function. Popular preference may inform design but cannot override core pedagogical requirements alone.

43. Anti-Patterns

Noncompliant patterns include shame-based copy, false praise, color-only diagrams, inaccessible time limits, untranslated jargon, checklist-only review, author self-approval for high-stakes content, hidden exceptions, and generated lessons published without domain review.

44. Constitutional Non-Negotiables

1. Learner-facing language MUST be respectful, precise, and actionable.
2. Accessibility MUST be considered during objective and assessment design.
3. Adaptations MUST preserve objective integrity or narrow the claim explicitly.
4. Color MUST NOT be the sole carrier of essential information.
5. Factual and pedagogical review MUST remain distinct.
6. High-consequence content MUST receive independent review.
7. Generated content MUST NOT bypass quality assurance.

8. Temporary noncompliance **MUST** be recorded as educational debt.
9. Material revisions **MUST** trigger impact analysis.
10. Learner data and engagement metrics **MUST NOT** independently define educational quality.

45. Conformance Tests

Reviewers must be able to identify the intended learner action, terminology, tone, accessibility pathway, objective integrity, factual authority, review evidence, version, exceptions, and post-release monitoring plan.

46. Tradeoffs and Resolution Rules

Clarity versus precision: simplify wording while preserving true relationships.

Consistency versus context: retain canonical terms but adapt examples and explanation depth.

Accessibility versus identical experience: prefer equivalent capability over identical interface.

Release speed versus confidence: consequence determines required review depth.

47. Assumptions Made

This chapter assumes FretGarden will support multiple content authors, automated systems, varied devices, and learners with diverse sensory, motor, cognitive, linguistic, and musical backgrounds.

48. Unresolved Questions

Unresolved matters include formal reviewer qualifications, localization governance, accessibility conformance targets, audit sampling rates, automated lint rules, and learner-record repair after content defects.

49. Topics Intentionally Deferred

Detailed legal compliance matrices, privacy governance, security standards, employment workflows, and complete localization style guides are deferred to organizational specifications.

50. Required Future Cross-References

Educational analytics, automated evaluation, constitutional governance, versioning, contributor workflow, research standards, and exception-management chapters must reference this chapter.

51. Chapter Conformance Statement

FretGarden content conforms only when it communicates accurately and respectfully, remains accessible through valid pathways, preserves objective integrity, and is released under documented evidence of factual, pedagogical, technical, editorial, and accessibility quality.